

It has been a great privilege and pleasure to have been the president of the North Canterbury Athletics club 2018/19.

I would like to thank Secretary Denise Pawsey who is a raft of information and works tirelessly in her role and has to deal with many challenging parents, Vice president John Marshall, Treasurer Natasha Mitchell who has kept the books under wraps for the year, Ian Purvis and our Children's coach Jo Ramsey and all other committee members and club members.

The club has four sections that compete throughout the year. During the summer children's athletics and senior athletics and the winter children's cross country and senior cross country.

The Children's athletics had another prosperous and rewarding year under the guidance of Coach Jo Ramsey. A new initiative of incorporating the North Canterbury community college students to undertake the coaching of the non competitive athletes was trialed. There were good numbers in this section but they did drop off towards the end of the term. Although this did fill the gap of these children getting some form of coaching a review of the program needs to be conducted to see if it is worth continuing with in and what form.

The club had its biggest contingent of athletes to the Colgate games in Dunedin of 20 competitors. Bringing home 16 medals – 3 gold, 5 silver 8 bronze. A notable purchase throughout the season was the new high jump mat and top pad and the new Long jump run way at New Life School. The Long Jump runway has had manufacturing and laying issues from day one (excessive glue spots and pitting of rubber). Ian Purvis and John Marshall have been instrumental in getting the issues resolved with AIS.

Senior athletics had a small number of three registered athletes for Saturday competition. Athletics Canterbury has been very pro active and encouraging 13 and 14 year olds to compete in the afternoons. Going forward to the future for the Club things are looking bright as some of the senior children are looking at carrying on to afternoon athletics.

Children's winter cross training had its biggest registration of children - 21. At the South Island cross country champs there were many top ten finishers with Zac, Aaron, Xanthe and Pippa gaining top three places.

The senior cross country has a small but very successful team. Often finishing on the podium as individuals or as team relays. Four members were selected to represent Canterbury at the National Cross country champs in Wellington John Marshall, Natasha Mitchell and Jo Ramsay. John Marshall and his small team of organizers and helpers staged a very well supported Greta Valley relay. Twenty eight teams entered on a magical sunny day in September. At this stage the club has set a date to run the event this year in September to carry on its growth.

A notable achievement for the club was marathon runner Adrienne Smith who achieved the feat of earning the Abbot 6 star medal - completing the 6 major world marathons.

A huge thank you to Ella Marshall, who designed a fantastic new logo for the club.

Moving forward the Club is in good hart, financially and with increasing members.

Alley Hendren